

Express Entry Starting Checklist

A practical sequence for skilled professionals preparing for Canadian Express Entry.

Where Dreams Take Flight

1. Define your starting point

- Confirm your age and family composition.
- List your completed education.
- Write a clean work-history timeline with dates and actual duties.
- Note any Canadian education, work or family factors that may be relevant.

2. Plan language testing

- Check which English and French tests IRCC currently accepts.
- Do not rely on an unofficial "overall score" alone; individual abilities matter.
- If you are bilingual, consider both languages as part of your preparation.

3. Check education assessment

- If you rely on foreign education, verify whether an Educational Credential Assessment (ECA) is required for your intended pathway or points.
- Follow the designated assessment organization's document rules exactly.

4. Organize evidence

- Identity and civil-status documents.
- Education records and ECA results where applicable.
- Work-experience evidence that is truthful and verifiable.
- Language results and their validity dates.
- Financial evidence where your program requires it.

5. Understand the Express Entry sequence

- Eligibility comes before ranking.
- Entering the pool is not the same as receiving an Invitation to Apply.
- CRS competitiveness can change across rounds and categories.
- Provincial nomination may be relevant for some candidates.

6. Before submitting anything

- Verify current requirements on Canada.ca.
- Make sure dates and facts are consistent across documents.
- Never alter or invent work, funds, education, relationships or travel history.
- Use an authorized representative for paid Canadian immigration advice or representation where required.

The Integrity question

Do not begin with an application. Begin with a strategy. What is the next verified step that improves your readiness?

General information only. Rules can change. Always verify official sources and use an authorized representative where a regulated service requires one.